

HASKELL

While largely ignored in favour of more traditional languages such as C, Java or Python, functional programming languages are beginning to make a comeback, particularly in the fields of analytics and big data. We take a look at one of the most popular functional languages out there, Haskell.

Haskell is the new kid on the block of programming languages. It too follows the computing paradigm called 'Functional Programming' i.e. approach a problem in terms of what the solution should look like, rather than what steps should be taken to get to that solution.

Though Haskell has risen in popularity in recent years, the language itself is more than 20 years old. As far back as 1987, there existed at least a dozen implementations of a purely functional language, and at the conference of Functional Programming Languages and Computer Architecture (FPLCA) in Portland, it was decided to publish an open standard for functional programming to promote it as an alternative style of programming.